We're not saying that all of these contradict each other. We're just noticing that in some cases, they might. And we believe that companies that have a lighthouse allowing them to navigate through unobvious decisions fare better—which is one of the value statements of this book.

That is the role of data value statements: to serve as the final word when in doubt. They won't affect your lives as often as the selection of this or that technology stack—just as seatbelts do not save your life every day. It's just that when they are needed, they are hard to substitute on the fly (pun intended). Therefore, value statements should not be taken lightly because they set up the expectations of the whole data environment of the company.

Discussion about data mesh value statements serves a double purpose:

- Deepening understanding of the data mesh within your governance body
- Providing a clear understanding of the data governance team's expectations from the data mesh (even if they won't end up in a final value statement list)

Defined value statements themselves are a powerful tool too. First, they allow you to discover organizational-level value added by data mesh development. Second, they will guide your implementation team members to prioritize development if time constraints won't allow them to finish all planned data products or the central infrastructure platform features.

At Messflix, your governance team has a long debate on the value statement. The team members list key areas of their operations as follows:

- Technical efficiency
- Financial efficiency
- Operational resilience
- Customer satisfaction

For MVP purposes, they decide to focus on the latter. They declare the following: